



Liquid Batteries

Ambri secures \$144 million for liquid metal battery commercialization.
<https://digit.in/sep21-59>



Norton buys Avast

Anti-virus giant Norton is all set to acquire Avast anti-virus for US\$8 billion.
<https://digit.in/sep21-60>

a sensor that tracks electrodermal activity to measure stress levels. The OPPO Watch estimates if you are exercising enough to burn fat. Samsung's Galaxy Watch 4 uses bioelectric impedance analysis to estimate the body fat. The key here is all of these are just estimations, using proxies and miniaturised sensors. General trends can be derived just because of the continuous data collection, and the sheer amount of data, but none of these measurements or data points can be considered to be clinically accurate compared to the gold standard tests used in actual laboratories - these are all merely indicators.

So even after all this, let us say you really want a smartwatch, then you want it for the data, and the data only. You are a fanatic about collecting data, and you want data around the clock, and you know how to use that data. In that case, the data from two smartwatches is better than data from one. So the answer is that you do not need one smartwatch at this point, you need at least two. If you are an endurance anything, a swimmer, a cyclist or an athlete, in most cases, you are better off with two. If you are a drummer who wants to measure and improve the number of strokes per minute, then again, you need two.

Depending on the operating system on your phone, this can be a Fitbit paired with either an Apple Watch with an ECG or a Samsung Galaxy watch with an ECG. Here the Fitbit devices are lighter, have battery lives that last for about a week, track sleep phases better, and can keep the data collection going while the other one is charging. If you want to measure the temperature also, then you need three. If you want to sport a regular old (or new!) dress watch as well, then better hide all these other abominations away in the upper arms or lower legs. We know this is getting ridiculous, but smartwatches at this point really are ridiculous! 

BUYING ADVICE

IS THE ONE PLUS WATCH A GOOD BET?

Q Hey Agent 001, One Plus smartwatch has 15 day battery life I've heard, 15 times more than Apple Watch. They say the Apple Watch is the best, but the One Plus has an incredible battery, far better and more reliable for treks and trips. They seem to have eclipsed Apple which has a 1 day battery life. I've read some crazy reviews, but wanted your opinion before pickup up the device.

—Ashwin

A Hello Ashwin, Just the fact that the battery life is your primary concern indicates that you are a watch aficionado and I suspect one who likes automatics at that. There are some things about the OnePlus watch that might be appealing to those looking to jump to smartwatches from real watches. The long battery life ("long" only for a smartwatch), the stainless steel frame (cobalt alloy in the limited edition), and the sapphire glass display

all work in its favour. You seem to be an outdoorsy kind of person, and might find the on board compass and barometer appealing as well.

However, the OnePlus watch has some crippling problems. If you own an iPhone, forget about the OnePlus watch as the OnePlus Health app is only available for download on Android smartphones. It is difficult to call this device "smart" when you cannot even install any

third party apps on it. There are no third party apps yet that support data collected by the OnePlus watch either. On top of that, the data that it does collect is unreliable, and out of whack when compared with other smartwatches. Even though there are some really cool watch faces available, the device does not even have an always on mode. Which makes sense when looking at it from a battery life perspective, but it would have been nice to at least have the option.

One of the biggest dangers of buying watches (or anything that you're going to wear really) online, smart or otherwise, is that you never quite know how they will fit on your wrist, and the OnePlus watch has a diameter of 46 mm, which is definitely on the larger side.

Consider instead the Fitbit Versa 2, priced in the same range as the OnePlus watch or shell out a bit more for the Fitbit Versa 3. Both are very capable devices with a battery life that easily lasts seven days, and three days with the GPS functionality turned on on the Versa 3. These models should be more than good enough to last for the entire duration of most treks. 



The OnePlus Watch